

Year 3 Science | Water Cycle Introduction

01 Learn & warm-up | Build confidence

Year 4 content preview: AC9S4U02 | Year 3 inquiry practice

Name: _____ Date: _____

Warm-up: where have you seen water?

Tell a partner two places. Then say what happens to a puddle on a warm day. It is fine to change your first idea.

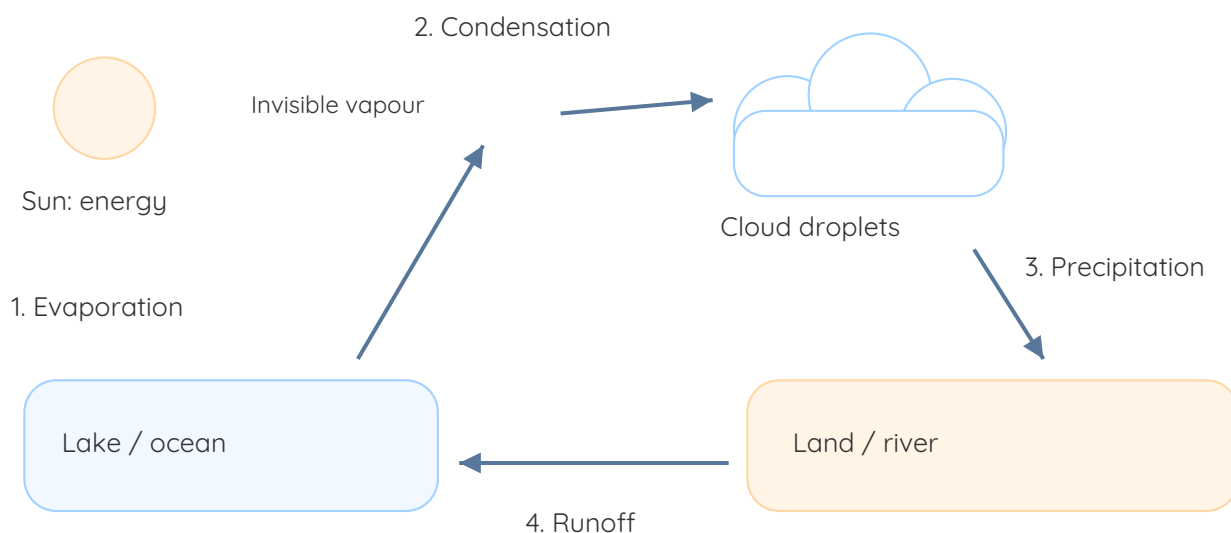
Learn the idea and keywords

Evaporation: liquid water becomes invisible water vapour (gas).

Condensation: water vapour cools and becomes liquid droplets.

Precipitation: water falls from clouds as rain, snow or hail.

Runoff: water flows over land. The Sun helps supply energy.



One route only: rain may also soak into soil or stay in a water store.

Three easy wins - use the diagram and keywords.

1. Name one water store: _____

2. Circle the process that brings rain down:
evaporation / precipitation

3. Liquid water changes into _____ during evaporation.

Say it: water changes form and moves; it is not simply destroyed.

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02 Practise | 03 Think & apply | 04 Challenge

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02 PRACTISE - easy to medium

A. Match. Write a letter beside each process.

1. Evaporation ___ 2. Condensation ___ 3. Precipitation ___

a. Water falls from clouds. b. Liquid becomes gas. c. Gas becomes liquid.

B. Label the changes.

Liquid to gas: _____ Gas to liquid: _____

C. Put this route in order. Write 1-3 beside the words.

Water leaves a lake, forms cloud droplets, then falls as rain.

precipitation ___ evaporation ___ condensation ___

D. What happens next? Vapour cools and changes into liquid

_____. Use a keyword from page 1.

03 THINK & APPLY - explain cause and effect

1. A wet shirt dries outside. Explain where some water goes and why the shirt does not have to boil.

2. "Clouds are only invisible gas." Correct this idea.

04 CHALLENGE - show your understanding

1. Compare evaporation and condensation. How are the changes different?

2. Rain falls onto dry soil. Predict where some water might go instead of flowing straight to the ocean. Explain your reason.

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05 Reflection & feedback | 06 Answers & adult guide

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05 STUDENT REFLECTION + TEACHER FEEDBACK

I did well at: _____

I need to practise: _____

My confidence: [] Need help [] Getting there [] Can explain

Teacher feedback / next step: _____

06 ANSWER KEY - clear answers and acceptable wording

Page 1: 1 lake, ocean, river, puddle or other valid water store. 2 precipitation. 3 water vapour / gas.

Practice A: 1-b, 2-c, 3-a. B: evaporation; condensation.

C: precipitation 3; evaporation 1; condensation 2.

D: droplets / water droplets.

Think 1: some liquid water evaporates into the air as gas; evaporation can happen without boiling. Think 2: clouds contain tiny liquid droplets and/or ice crystals; vapour is invisible gas.

Challenge 1: evaporation is liquid to gas; condensation is gas to liquid. Challenge 2: some rain may soak into soil or remain in a puddle. Accept a reason linked to that destination, such as soil absorbing water or water collecting in a hollow.

Adult notes - support, challenge and checking transfer

Read directions aloud as needed. Accept labelled drawings or oral explanations; note adult help. Reteach process meanings before spelling. For transfer, hide pages 1-2 and ask the child to explain a drying puddle. Check changes and reasons, not only process names.

Curriculum and sources - use the year label accurately

Year 3 introduction / Year 4 preview. Direct content: Year 4 AC9S4U02. Selected Year 3 modelling link: AC9S3I04. This is focused practice, not complete unit coverage. Sources: ACARA current description, Scootle and USGS Water Science School. Classroom impact untested.